

The Temple Church

No. 151

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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Temple Church is one of the oldest churches in London. It was built by the Knights Templar, a group of monks who protected people travelling to the Holy Land.

The Round Church was finished in 1185. It was based on an important church in Jerusalem. Inside the church are stone statues of important people, including William Marshal, who advised King John. The church is also linked to the Magna Carta, signed in 1215.

The front part of the church, called the Chancel, was built in 1240. Later, lawyers from the Inner Temple and Middle Temple moved into the area.

The church was changed and repaired many times. It was badly damaged during the Second World War and rebuilt 17 years later.

Today, Temple Church is still used for worship. It has a famous choir, holds concerts and talks, and is a peaceful place in the busy City of London.



Original doorway



William Marshal, Earl of Pembroke